

Looking Through the Lenses

A nostalgic device reimagined with technology.

Project Type
Interactive Installation

Role
Concept Creation, Video Content Creation, Tech Integration, Design and Installation

Project Duration
4 weeks

Display
Installed -VR Mall, Surat

Tools
AI Video Tools, Touch Designer, Adobe After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Hardware Regulators, Multi-screen Display System.

Total Components
Wooden Bioscope Structure, 6 Viewing Screens, Tech, Regulators

Team
4 members

Project Overview.

Looking Through the Lenses is an interactive installation that reimagines the traditional street-side bioscope for a contemporary setting. Created for the Dumas Art Festival, the project takes the form of a handcrafted wooden bioscope designed for six viewers, inspired by the nostalgic experience of looking through small lenses to watch moving images.

Inside, four looping surreal video artworks explore imaginative and speculative themes through cinematic storytelling and AI-generated visuals. Each viewer can independently switch between the videos using rotary regulators, making the experience personal and interactive.

The Concept

Looking Through the Lenses combines the nostalgia of the traditional street-side bioscope with contemporary technology. Its handcrafted wooden structure and individual viewing lenses preserve the curiosity and wonder of the original experience, while AI-generated surreal videos introduce contemporary storytelling.

Rotary regulators allow viewers to switch between four video artworks, adding a simple layer of interaction. By blending traditional craftsmanship, digital media, and interaction, the project reimagines the bioscope as a contemporary storytelling experience.

The Design Process

This section provides a road map for your explorations of our case study. Dive into each chapter to uncover the story of our project, from research and ideation to design and testing, leading to a user-centric solutions that sure to inspire.

Idea Exploration

Initial concept research

Concept Development

Defining installation approach

Content Creation

Surreal video development

Tech Integration

Hardware and software system setup

Installation and Execution

Final bioscope installation

Understanding the Bioscope Idea

- Researching the history and cultural significance of traditional bioscopes
- Exploring how nostalgia and curiosity shaped the viewing experience
- Identifying ways to reinterpret the device for a contemporary audience



Developing the Interactive System

- Designing the bioscope structure for six simultaneous viewers
- Integrating screens and rotary regulators for video switching
- Combining handcrafted construction with simple technological interaction

Creating the Surreal Video Content

- Developing four speculative video narratives for the bioscope
- Experimenting with AI-generated visuals and cinematic storytelling
- Exploring themes from everyday culture, including the surreal idea of tea extinction in Gujarat



Inside the Bioscope

Of the four videos presented inside the bioscope, this piece takes a surreal approach to reimagining an everyday reality. Through AI-generated visuals, cinematic sequences, and speculative storytelling, it creates a world that feels familiar yet strangely out of place.

Chai na Milegi Dubara

A speculative film imagining a world where tea becomes extinct in Gujarat.

The Concept

This video explores a surreal speculative scenario — a world where tea suddenly becomes extinct. In a place like Gujarat, where tea is deeply woven into everyday life and social culture, its disappearance creates a strange and unsettling reality. The film imagines how people who depend on tea as a daily ritual respond when something so ordinary suddenly vanishes. The visuals were first manually filmed using staged scenes and props based on a scripted narrative, and later transformed using AI tools to create surreal imagery. This process blends real footage with AI manipulation to build a dreamlike interpretation of a familiar cultural habit.

The video is one of the four looping narratives presented inside the bioscope installation. Viewers can switch to this film using the rotary regulators

THE LAST CUP OF TEA
2076